MASTER FUNCTIONAL SKILLS

FUNCTIONAL SKILLS ENGLISH

CORE REVISION GUIDE • FULL COMPREHENSION MANUAL

LEVEL 1



READING SKILLS

A step-by-step guide to full marks in Level 1 reading comprehension

Comprehension Skills | Text Types & Layout | Specialist Vocab | Mock Papers

MASTER FUNCTIONAL SKILLS · COMPLETE CURRICULUM DIRECTORY

Functional Skills English · Reading Level 1 · Table of Contents

Complete Study, Comprehension & Exam Practice Manual (DFE L1.9–L1.18)

PEARSON EDEXCEL REFORMED

SPECIFICATION & DIAGNOSTIC AUDIT — INTRO

SPEC	Pearson Edexcel L1.9–L1.18 Spec…	p.3
AUDIT	Candidate Baseline Skills Audit …	p.4

CORE READING TOPICS (R1–R12) — TOPICS

R1	Fact or Opinion	p.5
R2	Words in Context & Meaning	p.9
R3	Specialist & Technical Vocabulary	p.13
R4	Presentational Features	p.17
R5	Layout Devices & Visual Signpo…	p.21
R6	Images, Diagrams, Charts & Ca…	p.25
R7	Language Devices & Rhetorical …	p.29
R8	Point of View, Bias & Line of Arg…	p.33
R9	Tone, Style & Writer's Voice	p.37
R10	Text Types, Genre Conventions …	p.41
R11	Comparing Texts & Contrasting …	p.45
R12	The Writer's Purpose & Target A…	p.49

EXAM STRATEGY MASTERCLASSES (EX1–EX6) — EXAM

EX1	Managing Your Time: The 2-Min…	p.53
EX2	Retrieval Questions & Locating …	p.54
EX3	Working Out the Meaning of Unf…	p.55
EX4	Understanding Organisational &…	p.56
EX5	Distinguishing Fact, Opinion & B…	p.57
EX6	Final Checking & Two-Text Com…	p.58

OFFICIAL READING MOCK EXAM PAPERS — MOCKS

M1	Mock Exam Paper 1: Community…	p.59
M2	Mock Exam Paper 2: Council Ap…	p.67

OFFICIAL PEARSON EDEXCEL MARK SCHEMES — MARK

MS1–3	Retrieval, Layout & Fact/Opinio…	p.75
MS4–6	Vocabulary, Purpose & Compari…	p.78

SOLUTIONS, GLOSSARY, INDEX & READINESS — REF

SOL	Topic Drills & Mock 1–2 Full Solu…	p.81
GLOSS	Reading Terminology Glossary …	p.86
READY	Exam Day Readiness Commitme…	p.87

How to Use This Guide: Every Reading Topic follows a structured 4-page mastery cycle: **(1) Curriculum Blueprint & Visual Context**, **(2) Source Passage & Strategy Walkthrough**, **(3) Examiner Full-Marks Benchmark Model**, and **(4) Dual Comprehension Practice Drills** (with full worked solutions in the Reference Section).

CURRICULUM ARCHITECTURE • DFE SUBJECT CONTENT L1.9 TO L1.18

SPEC

Pearson Edexcel Level 1 Reading • Specification Overview

Official DfE Functional Skills English Level 1 Reading Standards (L1.9–L1.18)

Examination Format: Externally assessed **60-minute** paper worth **30 marks** across **two to three real-world non-fiction texts** (workplace policies, community notices, emails, websites, and articles). Dictionaries are not permitted; aim for **2 minutes per mark**.

Code	Official DfE / Pearson Edexcel Level 1 Reading Requirement	Core Topics	Pages
L1.9	Identify and understand the main points, ideas and details in texts	Topics 1, 2, 12	pp. 5, 9, 49
L1.10	Compare information, ideas and opinions in different texts	Topics 1, 11	pp. 5, 45
L1.11	Identify meanings in texts and distinguish between fact and opinion	Topics 1, 2	pp. 5, 9
L1.12	Recognise that language and other textual features can be varied to suit different audiences and purposes	Topics 7, 9, 10, 12	pp. 29, 37, 41, 49
L1.13	Use reference materials and appropriate strategies for a range of purposes, including to find the meaning of words	Topics 2, 3, 5	pp. 9, 13, 21
L1.14	Understand organisational and structural features and use them to locate Relevant information (e.g. index, menus, subheadings)	Topics 4, 5	pp. 17, 21
L1.15	Infer from images meanings not explicit in the accompanying text	Topic 6	p. 25
L1.16	Recognise vocabulary typically associated with specific types and purposes of texts (e.g. formal, informal, instructional, persuasive)	Topics 3, 7, 9, 10	pp. 13, 29, 37, 41
L1.17	Read and understand a range of specialist words in context	Topic 3	p. 13
L1.18	Use knowledge of punctuation to aid understanding of straightforward texts	Topics 4, 8, 9	pp. 17, 33, 37

Golden Reading Rule

Always re-read the specific paragraph referenced in the question before selecting or writing your answer.

Examiner Warning

Never rely on personal background knowledge — every mark must be evidenced directly from the source text.

AUDIT

BASELINE SKILLS AUDIT

Level 1 Candidate Diagnostic Matrix

Core Functional Skills Level 1 Reading Competencies

Evaluate your confidence across the core Level 1 Reading standards before starting:

- Can you quickly separate objective facts from personal opinions in a workplace article? (L1.11)
- Can you work out the meaning of unfamiliar or specialist words using surrounding context clues? (L1.13, L1.17)
- Can you explain how bullet points, subheadings, numbered lists, and bold text help the reader? (L1.14)
- Can you infer implicit meanings from workplace diagrams, safety symbols, and captions? (L1.15)
- Can you identify the main purpose and target audience of a text and compare two texts clearly? (L1.10, L1.12)

✎ Reading Skills I Need to Practise Most

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 1 READING

R1

Reading Topic 1: Fact or Opinion



Fact or Opinion: Evaluating objective facts versus promotional claims on a community gym flyer.

DfE Criteria & Core Concept

Curriculum Standard:

• **L1.13 / L2.11:** Identify and distinguish between fact and opinion in workplace, instructional, and informative texts.

• **L2.14:** Recognise bias, detect opinions disguised as facts, and determine whether statements represent verifiable truth or subjective evaluation.

Key Concept: A fact is verifiable using data, records, dates, measurements, or official statistics. If a statement can be checked against independent records and proven true or false, it is a fact — even if it sounds surprising.

Golden Rule

Opinions reflect personal feelings, beliefs, predictions, or recommendations. Look out for evaluative adjectives ('superb', 'appalling', 'vital', 'unfair') and modal verbs ('should', 'ought to').

Examiner Trap

Just because a senior doctor or chief executive says 'This is the best ward management app available', that does not make the claim itself a fact. It remains an informed professional opinion.

PASSAGE

AUTHENTIC WORKPLACE CONTEXT • COMMUNITY LEISURE CENTRE PROMOTION

Fact or Opinion • Text Analysis

Source Text • Community Leisure Centre Promotion

Extract • Distinguishing Fact and Opinion in a Gym Flyer (Level 1):

Read the extract from the leisure centre leaflet:
'Riverside Gym opens at 6:00 a.m. seven days a week and features 40 cardiovascular machines. Our friendly personal trainers deliver the most inspiring fitness classes in the region.'
(a) Extract **one fact** from the leaflet. [1 Mark]
(b) Extract **one opinion** from the leaflet. [1 Mark]

Tutor Step-by-Step Analysis Strategy

1. **Step 1 (Extract a verifiable factual statement):** 'Riverside Gym opens at 6:00 a.m. seven days a week' (or 'features 40 cardiovascular machines'). Both can be checked and proven. **[1 Mark [A1 Fact]]**
2. **Step 2 (Extract the subjective opinion statement):** 'Our friendly personal trainers deliver the most inspiring fitness classes in the region.' ('friendly' and 'most inspiring' are personal judgments). **[1 Mark [A1 Opinion]]**

✎ Key Clues & Vocabulary Notes

MODEL

EXAMINER FULL MARKS EXEMPLAR

Fact or Opinion • Benchmark Model Answer

Full Marks Benchmark • 2 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 1)

Model Candidate Answer:

(a) Fact: 'Riverside Gym opens at 6:00 a.m. seven days a week' (or has 40 machines). |
(b) Opinion: 'Our friendly personal trainers deliver the most inspiring fitness classes in the region.'

Examiner Guidance

At Level 1, copy the exact sentence or clause cleanly without changing the words.

Mark Scheme Criterion

If a sentence contains both a statistic and an emotive adjective ('The £50 ticket is a total rip-off') and you copy the entire sentence as a fact, you score 0 because 'total rip-off' is an opinion.

✎ What Makes This Answer Successful

DRILL

EXAM COMPREHENSION DRILLS • 2 MARKS + 2 MARKS

Fact or Opinion • Candidate Practice

▶ Independent Practice Tasks A & B • Fact or Opinion

Task A (2 Marks): A logistics fleet report states: *'The electric delivery vans cut depot fuel expenditure by £14,500 between January and June. They are undeniably the most stylish commercial vehicles on British roads today.'* Extract **one fact** and **one opinion** from this statement.

Task B (2 Marks): Read this mixed sentence from a restaurant review: *'The bistro charges £18.50 for its two-course lunch menu, which is an outrageous price for such tiny portions.'* Separate this single sentence into **one fact** and **one opinion**.



Drill: Separating verifiable facts from subjective opinions.

✎ Task A Response (2 Marks):

✎ Task B Response (2 Marks):

R2

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 1 READING

Reading Topic 2: Words in Context & Meaning



Words in Context: Using surrounding sentences to decode unfamiliar words on an office notice.

DfE Criteria & Core Concept

Curriculum Standard:

• **L1.10 / L2.10:** Understand vocabulary and determine how meaning is conveyed through word choice in context.

• **L1.9 / L2.11:** Identify and explain implicit (suggested) and explicit (stated) meanings across extended workplace texts.

Key Concept: When asked to give a word or phrase that can 'replace' a target word in the text, your answer MUST match the exact part of speech and verb tense (e.g., if the target word ends in '-ed' or '-ing', your replacement must also fit grammatically into the original sentence).

Golden Rule

Explicit meaning is stated directly on the page. Implicit meaning is hinted at between the lines — you must deduce it from clues, tone, and actions.

Examiner Trap

A word like 'reservations' can mean 'restaurant bookings' or 'doubts/concerns'. Giving 'bookings' when the text says 'The union had reservations about the contract' scores 0.

PASSAGE

AUTHENTIC WORKPLACE CONTEXT • OFFICE FACILITIES REFURBISHMENT

Words in Context & Meaning • Text Analysis

Source Text • Office Facilities Refurbishment

Extract • Word Replacement in a Workplace Notice (Level 1):

Read the sentence from the office manager's email:
*'The air-conditioning repairs are **mandatory** and will cause **minimal** disruption to reception staff.'*
(a) Give one word or phrase that can replace **'mandatory'** in this sentence. [1 Mark]
(b) Give one word or phrase that can replace **'minimal'** in this sentence. [1 Mark]

Tutor Step-by-Step Analysis Strategy

1. **Step 1 (Decode 'mandatory' in the context of safety repairs):** 'Mandatory' means required by rule or compulsory. Substituting 'compulsory' or 'essential' fits grammatically. **[1 Mark [A1 Meaning 1]]**
2. **Step 2 (Decode 'minimal' in the context of disruption):** 'Minimal' means very little, slight, or the smallest possible amount. **[1 Mark [A1 Meaning 2]]**

✎ Key Clues & Vocabulary Notes

MODEL

EXAMINER FULL MARKS EXEMPLAR

Words in Context & Meaning • Benchmark Model Answer

Full Marks Benchmark • 2 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 1)

Model Candidate Answer:

(a) Mandatory: compulsory / required / obligatory. | (b) Minimal: very little / slight / negligible.

Examiner Guidance

Test your word in the sentence: 'The repairs are compulsory and will cause very little disruption' — it makes complete grammatical sense!

Mark Scheme Criterion

If the question asks for a word to replace 'accelerated' (past tense verb) and you write 'speed up' (present tense) or 'fast' (adjective), it fails the grammatical substitution check.

✎ What Makes This Answer Successful

DRILL

EXAM COMPREHENSION DRILLS • 2 MARKS + 2 MARKS

Words in Context & Meaning • Candidate Practice

Independent Practice Tasks A & B • Words in Context & Meaning

Task A (2 Marks): A workshop safety notice reads: *'Failure to **isolate** electrical machinery prior to maintenance poses **imminent** danger to technicians.'*
Explain what is meant by **'isolate'** and **'imminent'** in this context.

Task B (2 Marks): Read this sentence from a council housing report:
*'The committee expressed grave **reservations** about building on the flood plain and voted to **defer** the decision until November.'*
Give one word or phrase to replace (a) **'reservations'** and (b) **'defer'**.



Drill: Matching workplace words with exact context syn...

✎ Task A Response (2 Marks):

✎ Task B Response (2 Marks):

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 1 READING

R3

Reading Topic 3: Specialist & Technical Vocabulary



Specialist Vocabulary: Using in-text brackets and context clues to define commercial kitchen terms.

DfE Criteria & Core Concept

Curriculum Standard:

• **L1.11 / L2.10:** Understand and explain specialist and technical vocabulary in vocational and regulatory texts.

• **L2.16:** Recognise how glossaries, parenthetical definitions, and prefixes/suffixes clarify technical terms for different audiences.

Key Concept: Informational texts frequently define technical acronyms or specialist terms immediately upon first mention using brackets, dashes, or appositive commas (e.g., 'tachycardia — an abnormally rapid heart rate — must be logged'). Always check adjacent punctuation!

Golden Rule

When no glossary is given, split compound specialist words into familiar building blocks (e.g., 'anti-' = against, 'co-' = together, 'mal-' = bad/faulty, 'cardio-' = heart, 'therm-' = heat, 'musculo-skeletal' = muscles and bones).

Examiner Trap

Candidates sometimes guess what an acronym like 'MAR' or 'PPE' stands for using everyday slang instead of scanning the text or footer glossary where the full expansion ('Medication Administration Record') is printed.

PASSAGE

AUTHENTIC WORKPLACE CONTEXT • CATERING KITCHEN INDUCTION MANUAL

Specialist & Technical Vocabulary • Text Analysis

Source Text • Catering Kitchen Induction Manual

Extract • Using In-Text Clues to Define Workplace Jargon (Level 1):

Read the extract from the food hygiene manual:
*'All raw poultry must be stored on the bottom shelf of the walk-in chiller to prevent **pathogens** (harmful bacteria that cause food poisoning) from dripping onto ready-to-eat foods and causing **cross-contamination**.'*
(a) According to the text, what are **'pathogens'**? [1 Mark]
(b) In your own words, explain what **'cross-contamination'** means in this sentence. [1 Mark]

Tutor Step-by-Step Analysis Strategy

1. **Step 1 (Locate the bracketed in-text definition for 'pathogens'):** The brackets immediately after 'pathogens' define them as 'harmful bacteria that cause food poisoning'. **[1 Mark [A1 In-Text Definition]]**
2. **Step 2 (Deduce 'cross-contamination' from the surrounding action):** It means the transfer/spreading of harmful bacteria from raw food (poultry) onto clean, ready-to-eat food. **[1 Mark [A1 Contextual Meaning]]**

✎ Key Clues & Vocabulary Notes

EXAMINER FULL MARKS EXEMPLAR

MODEL

Specialist & Technical Vocabulary • Benchmark Model Answer

Full Marks Benchmark • 2 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 1)

Model Candidate Answer:

(a) Pathogens: Harmful bacteria that cause food poisoning. | (b) Cross-contamination: When bacteria from raw food drip onto or spread to ready-to-eat food.

Examiner Guidance

Always check right next to a bold or unfamiliar word for brackets ( ) or dashes — examiners often hide the exact definition right there!

Mark Scheme Criterion

Defining 'biodegradable packaging' as 'packaging that degrades biologically' is too circular to guarantee the mark.

✎ What Makes This Answer Successful

EXAM COMPREHENSION DRILLS • 2 MARKS + 2 MARKS

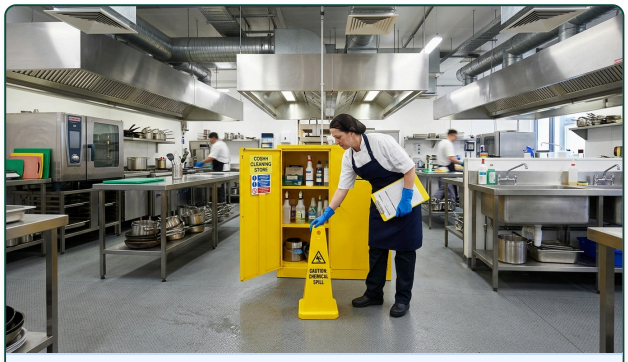
DRILL

Specialist & Technical Vocabulary • Candidate Practice

Independent Practice Tasks A & B • Specialist & Technical Vocabulary

Task A (2 Marks): A pharmacy dispensing notice states: *'This oral suspension is **contraindicated** for patients with severe **renal impairment**.'* Explain what is meant by (a) **'contraindicated'** and (b) **'renal impairment'**.

Task B (2 Marks): An IT security memo states: *'Staff must only access patient records via the Trust **intranet** and must never click links in suspected **phishing** emails.'* Explain the meaning of (a) **'intranet'** and (b) **'phishing'**.



Drill: Decoding technical food-safety and audit vocabul...

✎ Task A Response (2 Marks):

✎ Task B Response (2 Marks):

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 1 READING

R4

Reading Topic 4: Presentational Features



Presentational Features: Using bold headings, boxes, and bullet points on a clinic appointment letter.

DfE Criteria & Core Concept

Curriculum Standard:

• **L1.14 / L2.16:** Recognise and explain how presentational and organisational features aid understanding and convey information.

• **L2.17:** Analyse how formatting, typographic emphasis, and visual signposts support the writer's overall purpose.

Key Concept: You only get half the marks for naming a feature (e.g. 'bullet points' or 'bold heading'). To score full marks, state WHAT specific information the feature highlights in that text and HOW it helps the reader.

Golden Rule

Presentational features are visual formatting elements you can see without reading the words (bold, bullet points, subheadings, boxes, photos). Language features are word choices (metaphors, rhetorical questions, rule of three).

Examiner Trap

Alliteration, rhetorical questions, and metaphors are language techniques. Bold fonts, tables, bullet points, subheadings, and shaded boxes are presentational features.

PASSAGE

AUTHENTIC WORKPLACE CONTEXT • DIAGNOSTIC CLINIC APPOINTMENT LETTER

Presentational Features • Text Analysis

Source Text • Diagnostic Clinic Appointment Letter

Extract • Identifying Presentational Features in a Clinic Appointment Card (Level 1):

An outpatient letter includes the following formatted section:
WHAT TO BRING TO YOUR SCAN:
• Your appointment reference letter
• A list of your current prescribed tablets
IMPORTANT: Do not eat any solid food for 6 hours before your scan.
Identify **two presentational features** used in this extract and state what information each one highlights. [2 Marks]

Tutor Step-by-Step Analysis Strategy

1. **Step 1 (Identify Feature 1 and link to content):** Bullet points — used to list the two items the patient needs to bring to the scan clearly. **[1 Mark [A1 Feature 1]]**
2. **Step 2 (Identify Feature 2 and link to content):** Bold/capitalised text (and italics) — used on the heading 'WHAT TO BRING TO YOUR SCAN' and to emphasise the urgent fasting rule ('IMPORTANT: Do not eat...'). **[1 Mark [A1 Feature 2]]**

✎ Key Clues & Vocabulary Notes

MODEL

EXAMINER FULL MARKS EXEMPLAR

Presentational Features • Benchmark Model Answer

Full Marks Benchmark • 2 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 1)

Model Candidate Answer:

1. Bullet points: Clearly list the items the patient must bring. | 2. Bold and capital letters: Emphasise the section title and the crucial rule not to eat for 6 hours before the scan.

Examiner Guidance

Always mention what information the bullet points or bold text actually show!

Mark Scheme Criterion

Examiners award 0 marks for saying bullet points or subheadings 'make the text look nice/less boring'.

✎ What Makes This Answer Successful

DRILL

EXAM COMPREHENSION DRILLS • 2 MARKS + 2 MARKS

Presentational Features • Candidate Practice

▶ Independent Practice Tasks A & B • Presentational Features

Task A (2 Marks): A diagnostic clinic appointment booking webpage features a prominent yellow shaded box at the top stating: *'**URGENT:** Please arrive 15 minutes before your scheduled MRI scan.'*
Identify **two presentational features** used here and explain their purpose.



Drill: Explaining how headings and boxes guide the rea...

Task B (2 Marks): A staff intranet guide on claiming travel expenses includes underlined blue text reading: *'Click here to download the Mileage Claim Form (PDF)'*.
Name this presentational feature and explain how it helps employees.

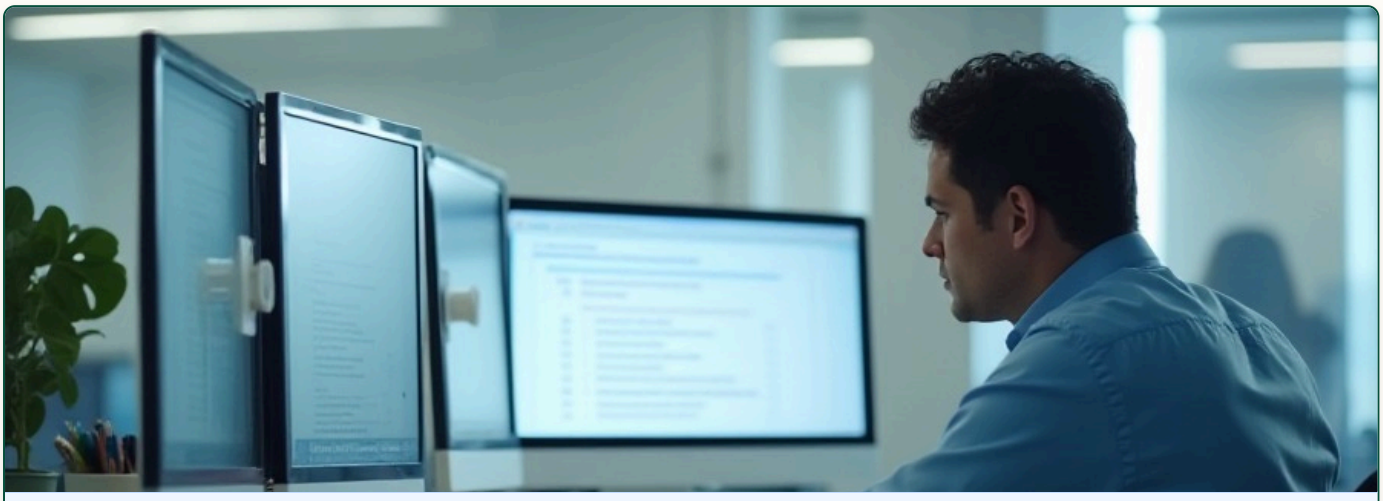
✎ Task A Response (2 Marks):

✎ Task B Response (2 Marks):

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 1 READING

R5

Reading Topic 5: Layout Devices & Visual Signposting



Layout Devices: Navigating subheadings, numbered lists, and sidebars on a staff intranet FAQ page.

DfE Criteria & Core Concept

Curriculum Standard:

- **L1.14 / L2.16:** Understand how layout and organisational devices structure complex information for rapid retrieval.
- **L2.17:** Analyse the relationship between textual hierarchy, columns, tables, sidebars, and reader navigation.

Key Concept: Page layout is engineered so the primary message occupies top prominence (banner headline), secondary themes are divided into columns or sub-sections, and reference details sit in sidebars or footers.

Golden Rule

Whenever a writer puts times, prices, dosages, or contact numbers into a table or sidebar instead of a paragraph, their goal is to enable instant cross-referencing without scanning walls of prose.

Examiner Trap

If asked about layout, summarizing the medical facts or repeating the opening hours scores 0. You must discuss columns, sidebars, tables, spacing, and visual hierarchy.

PASSAGE

AUTHENTIC WORKPLACE CONTEXT • HR ANNUAL LEAVE POLICY GUIDE

Layout Devices & Visual Signposting • Text Analysis

Source Text • HR Annual Leave Policy Guide

Extract • Navigating an FAQ Staff Intranet Page (Level 1):

A staff handbook page is laid out with three bold question headings:
Q1: How many days of annual leave do I get?
Q2: How do I carry over unused holiday into next year?
Q3: Who approves emergency compassionate leave?
(a) Which heading should an employee read if they have 3 days of holiday left in December that they want to use in January? [1 Mark]
(b) Why is this Question-and-Answer layout helpful for busy staff? [1 Mark]

Tutor Step-by-Step Analysis Strategy

1. **Step 1 (Match the employee's query to the exact heading):** Heading Q2 ('How do I carry over unused holiday into next year?') directly addresses moving unused holiday into the new year. **[1 Mark [A1 Navigation]]**
2. **Step 2 (Explain the benefit of the Q&A layout):** It allows staff to scan the bold questions and jump straight to the exact answer they need without reading the whole policy document. **[1 Mark [A1 Layout Purpose]]**

✎ Key Clues & Vocabulary Notes

EXAMINER FULL MARKS EXEMPLAR

MODEL

Layout Devices & Visual Signposting • Benchmark Model Answer

Full Marks Benchmark • 2 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 1)

Model Candidate Answer:

(a) Q2: How do I carry over unused holiday into next year? | (b) It lets staff quickly scan for their exact question and find the answer immediately without reading every paragraph.

Examiner Guidance

In navigation questions, always copy the heading label ('Q2') and its title accurately.

Mark Scheme Criterion

Simply writing 'There is a table' is an observation, not an explanation.

✎ What Makes This Answer Successful

EXAM COMPREHENSION DRILLS • 2 MARKS + 2 MARKS

DRILL

Layout Devices & Visual Signposting • Candidate Practice

Independent Practice Tasks A & B • Layout Devices & Visual Signposting

Task A (2 Marks): A staff intranet page presents monthly payroll submission cut-off dates and payday dates in a centred two-column table rather than continuous prose. Explain **two advantages** of this table layout for staff.

Task B (2 Marks): A first-aid poster for choking uses three boxes connected by large downward arrows: **Box 1: Encourage Coughing → Box 2: Give 5 Back Blows → Box 3: Give 5 Abdominal Thrusts**.
Identify this layout device and explain why it is effective in a medical emergency.



Drill: Using visual signposts and index tables to locate f...

✎ Task A Response (2 Marks):

✎ Task B Response (2 Marks):

R6

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 1 READING

Reading Topic 6: Images, Diagrams, Charts & Captions



Diagrams & Captions: Linking safety illustrations and captions to written warehouse lifting rules.

DfE Criteria & Core Concept

Curriculum Standard:

• **L1.14 / L2.16:** Analyse how images, diagrams, and graphical representations support or extend written content.

• **L2.17:** Evaluate the persuasive, emotional, and informational impact of visual imagery and captions in functional texts.

Key Concept: Images are never merely decorative in Functional Skills exams. Describe the specific visual detail shown in the image (e.g. a smiling apprentice in a hard hat, or a flooded high street) and explain how it proves or reinforces the writer's point.

Golden Rule

Captions, axis labels, and legends anchor the meaning of an image or graph. Examiners often hide a 1-mark retrieval fact inside an image caption or chart key that does not appear anywhere in the main body paragraphs!

Examiner Trap

Writing 'The picture shows a nurse so you know the text is about nurses' scores 0 at Level 2. You must explain WHY that specific depiction was chosen (e.g. to project frontline professionalism, reassurance, or urgency).

PASSAGE

AUTHENTIC WORKPLACE CONTEXT • WAREHOUSE LIFTING SAFETY GUIDE

Images, Diagrams, Charts & Captions • Text Analysis

Source Text • Warehouse Lifting Safety Guide

Extract • Interpreting a Manual Handling Diagram & Caption (Level 1):

A safety leaflet includes a diagram showing a worker lifting a heavy box with a straight back and bent knees, accompanied by a green tick icon and the caption: *'Figure 1: Hold the load close to your waist (maximum solo lift: 20 kg).'*
(a) According to the caption, what is the heaviest weight one worker should lift alone? [1 Mark]
(b) Why has the writer included this diagram alongside the written rules? [1 Mark]

Tutor Step-by-Step Analysis Strategy

1. **Step 1 (Retrieve the exact weight limit from the caption):** The caption states 'maximum solo lift: 20 kg'. **[1 Mark [A1 Caption Retrieval]]**
2. **Step 2 (Explain the functional purpose of the diagram):** The diagram visually shows staff the exact safe body posture (straight back, bent knees, load close to waist) so they can copy it easily and avoid back injury. **[1 Mark [A1 Diagram Purpose]]**

✎ Key Clues & Vocabulary Notes

EXAMINER FULL MARKS EXEMPLAR

MODEL

Images, Diagrams, Charts & Captions • Benchmark Model Answer

Full Marks Benchmark • 2 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 1)

Model Candidate Answer:

(a) 20 kg. | (b) Visually demonstrates the correct lifting posture (bent knees, straight back) so workers can easily see and copy the safe technique.

Examiner Guidance

Notice how the 20 kg figure was inside the caption — always read every word around a diagram!

Mark Scheme Criterion

Writing 'The picture is there for people who cannot read English' is a generic guess that examiners reject unless the text is specifically about international safety symbols.

✎ What Makes This Answer Successful

EXAM COMPREHENSION DRILLS • 2 MARKS + 2 MARKS

DRILL

Images, Diagrams, Charts & Captions • Candidate Practice

Independent Practice Tasks A & B • Images, Diagrams, Charts & Captions

Task A (2 Marks): A marine conservation poster includes a close-up photograph of a sea turtle entangled in a discarded plastic six-pack ring, alongside the caption: *'Over 100,000 marine animals die from plastic entanglement every year.'* Explain why the author used this photograph and caption together rather than just printing waste statistics.



Drill: Explaining how a safety diagram supports written ...

Task B (2 Marks): An engineering apprenticeship brochure features a photograph of a young female technician wearing safety goggles and operating a CNC laser cutter in a bright, modern workshop. Give **two reasons** why the college selected this specific photograph for the brochure.

✎ Task A Response (2 Marks):

✎ Task B Response (2 Marks):

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 1 READING

R7

Reading Topic 7: Language Devices & Rhetorical Techniques



Language Devices: Spotting rule of three, rhetorical questions, and direct address in a cycling flyer.

DfE Criteria & Core Concept

Curriculum Standard:

• **L1.12 / L2.13:** Identify language techniques and explain how they convey meaning and influence the reader.

• **L2.14 / L2.15:** Analyse rhetorical devices used to persuade, inform, critique, or advocate across multiple texts.

Key Concept: To score full marks on language questions in Pearson Edexcel, follow the 3-step formula: 1. Technique Name -> 2. Direct Quote -> 3. Specific impact on reader thoughts/feelings.

Golden Rule

The 'Rule of Three' creates rhythm and completeness; 'Direct Address' ('you') places personal responsibility on the reader; 'Emotive Language' triggers strong feelings like guilt, pride, or urgency.

Examiner Trap

Writing 'it catches the reader's eye and makes them read on' is the #1 reason candidates lose the effect mark on language questions.

AUTHENTIC WORKPLACE CONTEXT • SUSTAINABLE COMMUTING INITIATIVE

PASSAGE

Language Devices & Rhetorical Techniques • Text Analysis

Source Text • Sustainable Commuting Initiative

Extract • Spotting Persuasive Language in a Cycling Campaign Flyer (Level 1):

Read the extract from a staff cycling flyer:
'Pedal to work for a healthier heart, a happier mood, and a heavier wallet! Over 78% of staff who switched to our Cycle-to-Work scheme saved at least £600 on fuel last year.'
Identify **two language features** used in this extract and copy the example for each. [2 Marks]

Tutor Step-by-Step Analysis Strategy

1. **Step 1 (Identify Feature 1 and quote):** Rule of three (and alliteration of 'h' / 'w'): 'a healthier heart, a happier mood, and a heavier wallet!' **[1 Mark [A1 Feature 1]]**
2. **Step 2 (Identify Feature 2 and quote):** Statistics / numerical facts: '78% of staff' and 'saved at least £600 on fuel'. **[1 Mark [A1 Feature 2]]**

✎ Key Clues & Vocabulary Notes

EXAMINER FULL MARKS EXEMPLAR

MODEL

Language Devices & Rhetorical Techniques • Benchmark Model Answer

Full Marks Benchmark • 2 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 1)

Model Candidate Answer:

1. Rule of three (or alliteration): 'a healthier heart, a happier mood, and a heavier wallet'. | 2. Statistics: '78% of staff' / 'saved at least £600'.

Examiner Guidance

Statistics and percentages are one of the easiest and safest language features to spot in any exam!

Mark Scheme Criterion

Writing 'bold letters' or 'bullet points' on a language question scores 0.

✎ What Makes This Answer Successful

EXAM COMPREHENSION DRILLS • 2 MARKS + 2 MARKS

DRILL

Language Devices & Rhetorical Techniques • Candidate Practice

Independent Practice Tasks A & B • Language Devices & Rhetorical Techniques

Task A (2 Marks): A union safety flyer states: *'Exhausted nurses make dangerous mistakes. Safe ward staffing is a matter of life and death.'* Identify **one language technique** used in this extract and explain its intended effect on the reader.

Task B (2 Marks): Read this extract from a local charity advert: *'For the price of your morning coffee (£3.50), you can provide a hot meal and a warm blanket for a homeless veteran tonight.'* Identify **two language features** used to persuade the reader to donate.



Drill: Identifying persuasive devices and statistics in co...

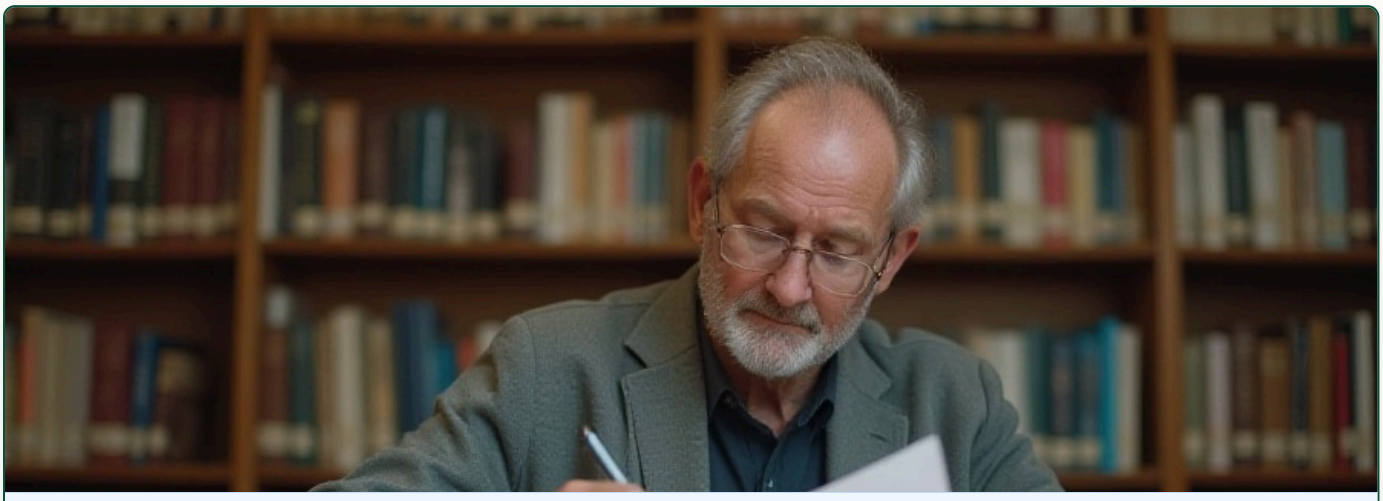
✎ Task A Response (2 Marks):

✎ Task B Response (2 Marks):

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 1 READING

R8

Reading Topic 8: Point of View, Bias & Line of Argument



Point of View & Bias: Identifying the writer's stance and supporting reasons in a library consultation.

DfE Criteria & Core Concept

Curriculum Standard:

• **L1.9 / L2.11:** Identify the writer's main point of view, attitude, and line of argument across extended texts.

• **L2.14:** Recognise bias and determine whether arguments are balanced or one-sided, evaluating the strength of supporting evidence.

Key Concept: A line of argument is the logical chain a writer builds: 1. Opening Claim (what they believe is wrong/right), 2. Supporting Reasons & Evidence (why they believe it), and 3. Final Call to Action (what must happen next).

Golden Rule

A balanced text considers both advantages and disadvantages before reaching a measured verdict. A biased text suppresses counter-arguments, uses loaded language, or stems from a vested financial/personal interest.

Examiner Trap

When a writer mentions an opposing view in order to argue against it ('While some claim X, the reality is Y'), candidates sometimes mistakenly report X as the writer's opinion.

PASSAGE

AUTHENTIC WORKPLACE CONTEXT • LOCAL LIBRARY CONSULTATION LETTER

Point of View, Bias & Line of Argument • Text Analysis

Source Text • Local Library Consultation Letter

Extract • Identifying Point of View and Supporting Reasons (Level 1):

Read this extract from a resident's letter to the council:
'Closing Oakwood Library on Saturdays is a terrible mistake. Saturday is the only day working parents can bring their children to borrow books, and elderly residents rely on the Saturday computer club to pay their bills online.'
(a) What is the writer's point of view on closing the library on Saturdays? [1 Mark]
(b) Give **two reasons** the writer uses to support their argument. [1 Mark]

Tutor Step-by-Step Analysis Strategy

1. **Step 1 (State the writer's stance clearly):** The writer is strongly against closing Oakwood Library on Saturdays (calls it 'a terrible mistake'). **[1 Mark [A1 Point of View]]**
2. **Step 2 (Extract the two supporting reasons):** 1. Working parents can only bring their children to borrow books on Saturdays. 2. Elderly residents rely on the Saturday computer club to pay bills online. **[1 Mark [A1 Supporting Reasons]]**

✎ Key Clues & Vocabulary Notes

EXAMINER FULL MARKS EXEMPLAR

MODEL

Point of View, Bias & Line of Argument • Benchmark Model Answer

Full Marks Benchmark • 2 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 1)

Model Candidate Answer:

(a) Strongly opposes closing Oakwood Library on Saturdays. | (b) 1. Working parents can only take children on Saturdays. 2. Elderly residents need the Saturday computer club to pay bills.

Examiner Guidance

Always state clearly whether the writer is 'in favour of' (supports) or 'against' (opposes) the proposal.

Mark Scheme Criterion

Just because an author writes with strong conviction and dramatic adjectives does not mean their line of argument is factually proven.

✎ What Makes This Answer Successful

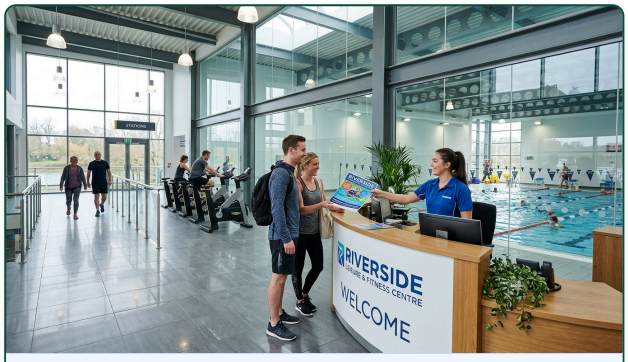
EXAM COMPREHENSION DRILLS • 2 MARKS + 3 MARKS

DRILL

Point of View, Bias & Line of Argument • Candidate Practice

Independent Practice Tasks A & B • Point of View, Bias & Line of Argument

Task A (2 Marks): A trade union newsletter argues: *'The proposed shift roster overhaul is an unmitigated disaster designed solely to exploit loyal warehouse staff.'*
Identify the author's stance and explain why the phrasing demonstrates **bias**.



Drill: Tracing a writer's argument and spotting bias clues.

Task B (3 Marks): Read this extract from a town planning report:
'Some high-street retailers fear that pedestrianising Market Street will reduce passing car trade. However, evidence from 14 comparable UK market towns demonstrates that pedestrian zones increase footfall by 28% and reduce empty shop units by half. Therefore, the council should approve the pedestrian zone immediately.'
Trace the writer's **line of argument** across the three sentences. [3 Marks]

✎ Task A Response (2 Marks):

✎ Task B Response (3 Marks):

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 1 READING

R9

Reading Topic 9: Tone, Style & Writer's Voice



Tone & Writer's Voice: Recognising a reassuring, encouraging tone in a patient guidance leaflet.

DfE Criteria & Core Concept

Curriculum Standard:

• **L1.15 / L2.15:** Identify the tone and style of texts and explain how register, vocabulary, and grammar communicate attitude.

• **L2.16:** Evaluate how the writer's voice establishes credibility, empathy, urgency, or professional detachment.

Key Concept: Tone is not WHAT is said, but HOW it sounds if spoken aloud: reassuring, urgent, apologetic, sarcastic, enthusiastic, cautionary, or matter-of-fact. Always use a precise adjective to name the tone.

Golden Rule

Formal style uses passive voice, complex sentences, and specialist vocabulary to project authority. Conversational/informal style uses contractions, questions, and friendly idioms to build warmth and rapport.

Examiner Trap

A text about a serious road accident might be written in a detached, factual, clinical tone (e.g. a police log) rather than an emotional one.

PASSAGE

AUTHENTIC WORKPLACE CONTEXT • FIRST-TIME BLOOD DONATION GUIDE

Tone, Style & Writer's Voice • Text Analysis

Source Text • First-Time Blood Donation Guide

Extract • Identifying Tone and Style in a Patient Leaflet (Level 1):

Read this extract from a leaflet for first-time blood donors:
'Feeling a little nervous about your first donation? That is completely normal! Our warm, friendly nurses will chat with you every step of the way, and the needle pinch lasts less than a second.'
(a) Describe the **tone** of this extract. [1 Mark]
(b) Quote **one phrase** that helps create this tone. [1 Mark]

Tutor Step-by-Step Analysis Strategy

1. **Step 1 (Identify the writer's attitude toward nervous donors):** The tone is reassuring, comforting, friendly, and supportive. **[1 Mark [A1 Tone Label]]**
2. **Step 2 (Quote a specific reassuring phrase):** 'That is completely normal!' or 'Our warm, friendly nurses will chat with you every step of the way'. **[1 Mark [A1 Supporting Quote]]**

✎ Key Clues & Vocabulary Notes

MODEL

EXAMINER FULL MARKS EXEMPLAR

Tone, Style & Writer's Voice • Benchmark Model Answer

Full Marks Benchmark • 2 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 1)

Model Candidate Answer:

(a) Tone: Reassuring, friendly, and comforting. | (b) Quote: 'That is completely normal!' (or 'Our warm, friendly nurses will chat with you every step of the way').

Examiner Guidance

'Reassuring' is one of the highest-scoring tone words whenever a healthcare or customer leaflet calms a reader's worries.

Mark Scheme Criterion

At Level 2, writing 'the tone is negative' is too broad to secure full marks.

✎ What Makes This Answer Successful

DRILL

EXAM COMPREHENSION DRILLS • 2 MARKS + 2 MARKS

Tone, Style & Writer's Voice • Candidate Practice

Independent Practice Tasks A & B • Tone, Style & Writer's Voice

Task A (2 Marks): A dental hygiene flyer asks:
'Hate flossing? We get it — it feels like a total chore at bedtime! But just two minutes a night will keep your gums healthy and save you painful bills.'
Describe the **style/tone** of this extract and quote **one colloquial (informal) phrase**.



Drill: Selecting words that reveal whether tone is reassu...

Task B (2 Marks): Read this extract from a laboratory safety protocol:
'Protective eye shields must be worn at all times. Unauthorised personnel are strictly prohibited from entering the centrifuge room.'
Describe the **tone and style** of this extract and identify **one grammatical feature** that creates it.

✎ Task A Response (2 Marks):

✎ Task B Response (2 Marks):

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 1 READING

R10

Reading Topic 10: Text Types, Genre Conventions & Audience



Text Types & Conventions: Identifying instructional features in a clinical sharps disposal SOP.

DfE Criteria & Core Concept

Curriculum Standard:

- **L1.16 / L2.17:** Identify different text types, purposes, and audiences across informational, instructional, and transactional materials.
- **L2.16:** Recognise structural and formatting conventions distinguishing reports, articles, forums, manuals, and formal correspondence.

Key Concept: Every text type has a visual fingerprint: Letters have addresses, date, and 'Dear.../Yours...'; Reports have numbered sections (1.0 Introduction, 2.0 Findings, 3.0 Recommendations); Forums have usernames, timestamps, and 'Reply' buttons.

Golden Rule

Never write 'anyone' or 'the general public' for an audience question if the text is aimed at a specific group (e.g. 'parents of primary school children', 'HGV drivers at the depot', or 'first-time homebuyers').

Examiner Trap

In Pearson Edexcel Level 2 exams, writing 'To inform' or 'To persuade' on its own scores 0 marks! The mark scheme requires you to state WHAT the text is informing or persuading the reader about.

AUTHENTIC WORKPLACE CONTEXT • HOSPITAL CLINICAL WASTE PROTOCOL

PASSAGE

Text Types, Genre Conventions & Audience • Text Analysis

Source Text • Hospital Clinical Waste Protocol

Extract • Identifying Text Type and Purpose of a Safety SOP (Level 1):

Read this extract from a workplace wall chart:
SAFE DISPOSAL OF SHARPS (NEEDLES & SYRINGES)
1. Never re-sheath a used needle by hand.
2. Place the needle and syringe immediately into the yellow UN-approved sharps bin.
3. Lock the bin lid permanently once contents reach the black fill line.
(a) Identify the **type of text**. [1 Mark]
(b) State its **main purpose**. [1 Mark]

Tutor Step-by-Step Analysis Strategy

1. **Step 1 (Identify the genre from numbered imperative steps):** Instructional notice / Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) / safety instruction guide. **[1 Mark [A1 Text Type]]**
2. **Step 2 (State the primary purpose using an action verb):** To instruct healthcare staff step-by-step on how to dispose of used needles and syringes safely without injury. **[1 Mark [A1 Purpose]]**

✎ Key Clues & Vocabulary Notes

EXAMINER FULL MARKS EXEMPLAR

MODEL

Text Types, Genre Conventions & Audience • Benchmark Model Answer

Full Marks Benchmark • 2 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 1)

Model Candidate Answer:

(a) Safety instruction notice / Standard Operating Procedure (SOP). | (b) To instruct healthcare staff on the safe step-by-step disposal of sharp medical instruments.

Examiner Guidance

Always include the topic ('how to dispose of used needles safely') when stating the purpose — never just write 'to instruct'!

Mark Scheme Criterion

If a text shows 3 or 4 different usernames (e.g. '@Dave_Builds', '@Sarah_N') posting separate replies under a question thread, it is an online discussion forum, not a single-author article.

✎ What Makes This Answer Successful

EXAM COMPREHENSION DRILLS • 2 MARKS + 2 MARKS

DRILL

Text Types, Genre Conventions & Audience • Candidate Practice

Independent Practice Tasks A & B • Text Types, Genre Conventions & Audience

Task A (2 Marks): A webpage displays a thread titled *'Best waterproof work boots for winter site work?'* followed by posts from **@BricklayerDan (Posted 10 mins ago)** and **@SparkyJen (Posted 4 mins ago)**.
Identify the **text type** and explain why someone would read it.



Drill: Distinguishing mandatory instructions from gener...

Task B (2 Marks): Read the header of this workplace document:
MEMORANDUM | To: All Outpatient Receptionists | From: Practice Manager | Date: 12 October | Subject: Updated Prescription Exemption Checks
Identify the **target audience** and the **main purpose** of this document.

✎ Task A Response (2 Marks):

✎ Task B Response (2 Marks):

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 1 READING

R11

Reading Topic 11: Comparing Texts & Contrasting Perspectives



Comparing Texts: Contrasting two retail staff reviews of a new self-service checkout system.

DfE Criteria & Core Concept

Curriculum Standard:

• **L1.10 / L2.12:** Compare information, ideas, and perspectives across multiple extended texts on the same topic.

• **L2.15 / L2.18:** Synthesize evidence from multiple sources, comparing how writers use language and tone to convey agreement or disagreement.

Key Concept: Never write about Text A in one isolated paragraph and Text B in another. Weave them together in the same sentence using comparative discourse markers: 'Similarly', 'Both texts agree that', 'Whereas', 'In sharp contrast', 'On the other hand'.

Golden Rule

High-scoring Level 2 comparative answers contrast not only factual claims, but also the authors' underlying attitudes (optimistic vs sceptical) and how they use language (statistics vs emotive hyperbole).

Examiner Trap

Summarizing Text A in one block and Text B in a separate block without linking connectives caps your score heavily.

AUTHENTIC WORKPLACE CONTEXT • RETAIL STORE TECHNOLOGY FEEDBACK

PASSAGE

Comparing Texts & Contrasting Perspectives • Text Analysis

Source Text • Retail Store Technology Feedback

Extract • Comparing Two Staff Reviews of a New Cashless Till System (Level 1):

Read the two staff comments:
Text A (Supervisor): *'The new card-only self-service tills have cut lunchtime queue times in half and eliminated end-of-day cash counting errors.'*
Text B (Cashier): *'Although queues move faster at lunchtime, elderly customers who budget with cash feel excluded and frustrated by the card-only rule.'*
(a) Identify **one similarity** between Text A and Text B. [1 Mark]
(b) Identify **one difference** between their views. [1 Mark]

Tutor Step-by-Step Analysis Strategy

1. **Step 1 (Identify shared agreement):** Both Text A and Text B agree that the new tills have made lunchtime queues faster. **[1 Mark [A1 Similarity]]**
2. **Step 2 (Contrast their overall attitude toward going cashless):** Text A views the card-only tills purely positively (eliminating cash counting errors), whereas Text B points out that elderly customers who rely on cash feel excluded and frustrated. **[1 Mark [A1 Difference]]**

✎ Key Clues & Vocabulary Notes

EXAMINER FULL MARKS EXEMPLAR

MODEL

Comparing Texts & Contrasting Perspectives • Benchmark Model Answer

Full Marks Benchmark • 2 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 1)

Model Candidate Answer:

(a) Similarity: Both agree that lunchtime queues move faster. | (b) Difference: Text A praises the card-only rule for stopping cash errors, whereas Text B criticises it for excluding elderly customers who pay with cash.

Examiner Guidance

Look for concession clauses starting with 'Although' — writers often agree with the other text in that opening clause before stating their disagreement!

Mark Scheme Criterion

If a Level 2 question asks you to compare how two texts convey their views and you only include quotations from Text A, you cannot achieve top-band marks.

✎ What Makes This Answer Successful

EXAM COMPREHENSION DRILLS • 3 MARKS + 3 MARKS

DRILL

Comparing Texts & Contrasting Perspectives • Candidate Practice

Independent Practice Tasks A & B • Comparing Texts & Contrasting Perspectives

Task A (3 Marks): Read the two extracts on remote GP appointments:
Text A (Health App Brochure): *'Video consultations empower busy workers by eliminating travel time and cutting waiting room infection risks by 50%.'*
Text B (Age Charity Report): *'Replacing face-to-face appointments with smartphone apps alienates elderly patients who lack digital skills or fast broadband.'*
Compare the viewpoints and language of Text A and Text B. [3 Marks]



Drill: Writing a linked comparison across two short texts.

Task B (3 Marks): Read the two extracts on a proposed four-day working week (32 hours for 100% pay):
Text A (HR Trial Summary): *'During our six-month four-day week trial, staff sick leave dropped by 62% and overall company revenue rose by 8%.'*
Text B (Retail Franchise Owner): *'Four-day weeks may work for desk jobs, but small shops open seven days a week would be forced to hire extra part-time staff and go bankrupt!'*
Compare how the two writers present the four-day working week.

✎ Task A Response (3 Marks):

✎ Task B Response (3 Marks):

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 1 READING

R12

Reading Topic 12: The Writer's Purpose & Target Audience



Purpose & Audience: Identifying why an apprentice induction guide was written and who it helps.

DfE Criteria & Core Concept

Curriculum Standard:

• **L1.16 / L2.17:** Identify the writer's main purpose and sub-purposes and determine why texts were produced.

• **L2.18:** Analyse how purpose and target audience shape vocabulary choice, tone, layout, and calls to action.

Key Concept: Never write 'To inform' or 'To persuade' on its own! Pearson Edexcel mark schemes require the full formula: 'To [Purpose Verb] the reader about [Specific Topic and Action]'.

Golden Rule

A text may spend three paragraphs giving factual statistics, but if the final sentence says 'Sign our petition before Friday' or 'Book your free eye test today', its overarching main purpose is to persuade/promote!

Examiner Trap

A text may contain plenty of facts and statistics, but if those facts are selected to convince you to buy a product, donate money, or sign a petition, its main purpose is to persuade.

AUTHENTIC WORKPLACE CONTEXT • APPRENTICE INDUCTION ADVICE SHEET

PASSAGE

The Writer's Purpose & Target Audience • Text Analysis

Source Text • Apprentice Induction Advice Sheet

Extract • Identifying Purpose and Audience of a Workplace Guide (Level 1):

Read this extract from a college booklet:
'Starting your first carpentry apprenticeship can feel overwhelming! To make a great impression in week one, you should pack two sharp pencils, arrive 10 minutes before your site supervisor, and never hesitate to ask questions if a power tool feels unfamiliar.'
(a) What is the **main purpose** of this extract? [1 Mark]
(b) Who is the specific **target audience**? [1 Mark]

Tutor Step-by-Step Analysis Strategy

1. **Step 1 (Identify the purpose verb + specific topic):** The text uses supportive suggestions ('you should', 'never hesitate to') to advise and reassure new apprentices on how to succeed in their first week on site. **[1 Mark [A1 Purpose + Topic]]**
2. **Step 2 (Identify the specific target audience):** New carpentry apprentices (or trainees starting their first construction apprenticeship). **[1 Mark [A1 Specific Audience]]**

✎ Key Clues & Vocabulary Notes

EXAMINER FULL MARKS EXEMPLAR

MODEL

The Writer's Purpose & Target Audience • Benchmark Model Answer

Full Marks Benchmark • 2 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 1)

Model Candidate Answer:

(a) To advise and reassure new carpentry apprentices on how to prepare and succeed during their first week at work. | (b) First-year carpentry apprentices.

Examiner Guidance

Notice how the answer states 'To advise new carpentry apprentices on how to succeed in their first week' — including the topic secures the mark!

Mark Scheme Criterion

Writing 'To inform' without explaining what the text informs the reader about scores 0 marks on Pearson Edexcel Level 1 and Level 2 papers.

✎ What Makes This Answer Successful

EXAM COMPREHENSION DRILLS • 2 MARKS + 2 MARKS

DRILL

The Writer's Purpose & Target Audience • Candidate Practice

Independent Practice Tasks A & B • The Writer's Purpose & Target Audience

Task A (2 Marks): A hospice director publishes a newspaper article titled: *'Dignity at the End: Why Community Palliative Care Deserves Equal Public Health Funding.'*
State the writer's **main purpose** and **target audience**.

Task B (2 Marks): Read this extract from a home energy guide:
'If you want to cut £150 off your winter heating bill without spending a penny, try bleeding your radiators in October and moving sofas at least 30 cm away from wall heaters.'
Is the main purpose of this extract to **instruct** or to **advise**? Explain your answer.



Drill: Identifying main purpose and target audience.

✎ Task A Response (2 Marks):

✎ Task B Response (2 Marks):

PEARSON EDEXCEL READING STRATEGY

EX1

Exam Masterclass 1: Managing Your Time: The 2-Minutes-Per-Mark Rule



Exam Pacing Strategy: Allocating 10 minutes for initial reading, 40 minutes for questions, and 10 minutes for checking.

Core Examination Technique

In a 60-minute exam for 30 marks, you have exactly 2 minutes per mark. Allocate your time systematically: 10 minutes reading the source texts, 40 minutes answering questions, and 10 minutes checking.

Top Scoring Strategy

Read questions first so you read each passage with a clear purpose.

Common Exam Pitfall

Never get stuck on a 1-mark question for more than 2 minutes.

My Exam Strategy Notes & Personal Rules (Masterclass 1)

PEARSON EDEXCEL READING STRATEGY

EX2

Exam Masterclass 2: Retrieval Questions & Locating Exact Facts



Scanning & Retrieval: Locating names, dates, numbers, and key phrases rapidly without copying whole paragraphs.

Core Examination Technique

Retrieval questions ask you to find a specific piece of information (who, what, where, when, how much). Scan for capital letters, dates, numbers, and key action verbs.

Top Scoring Strategy

Keep retrieval answers concise, accurate, and factual.

Common Exam Pitfall

Do not copy entire paragraphs when only one phrase or statistic is needed.

✎ My Exam Strategy Notes & Personal Rules (Masterclass 2)

PEARSON EDEXCEL READING STRATEGY

EX3

Exam Masterclass 3: Working Out the Meaning of Unfamiliar Words



Vocabulary in Context: Reading the sentences before and after an unfamiliar word to test a synonym replacement.

Core Examination Technique

When encountering specialist or unfamiliar words, read the sentence before and the sentence after. The surrounding context almost always provides a clue, synonym, or explanation.

Top Scoring Strategy

Check whether brackets, dashes, or a footnote define the term.

Common Exam Pitfall

Substitute your chosen word back into the sentence to check grammar and sense.

✎ My Exam Strategy Notes & Personal Rules (Masterclass 3)

PEARSON EDEXCEL READING STRATEGY

EX4

Exam Masterclass 4: Understanding Organisational & Layout Features



Organisational Features: Explaining specifically how headings, bullet points, and tables help the reader.

Core Examination Technique

Writers use main headings to state the overall topic, subheadings to divide sections, bullet points to list key items concisely, and bold text or boxes to highlight urgent alerts.

Top Scoring Strategy

Always explain HOW the feature helps the reader (e.g. 'helps staff find rules quickly').

Common Exam Pitfall

Never write vague answers like 'it looks nice' or 'it stands out'.

✎ My Exam Strategy Notes & Personal Rules (Masterclass 4)

PEARSON EDEXCEL READING STRATEGY

EX5

Exam Masterclass 5: Distinguishing Fact, Opinion & Bias



Fact vs Opinion Mastery: Checking whether a statement can be proven with records or expresses a value judgment.

Core Examination Technique

A fact can be proven true using records, measurements, or statistics. An opinion expresses personal belief, feelings, or value judgments ('best', 'unacceptable', 'undoubtedly').

Top Scoring Strategy

Facts can be verified; opinions reflect feelings or judgments.

Common Exam Pitfall

Watch out for opinions hidden inside quotes from staff or customers.

My Exam Strategy Notes & Personal Rules (Masterclass 5)

PEARSON EDEXCEL READING STRATEGY

EX6

Exam Masterclass 6: Final Checking & Two-Text Comparison Strategy



Final Proofreading & Comparison: Verifying every multiple-choice box and linking Text A and Text B clearly.

Core Examination Technique

Use your final 10 minutes to verify every answer. For comparison questions, pair a point from Text A directly with a matching point from Text B using 'both', 'however', or 'whereas'.

Top Scoring Strategy

Even an educated guess on a multiple-choice question gives a 25% chance.

Common Exam Pitfall

Check that you have copied dates, phone numbers, and figures accurately.

My Exam Strategy Notes & Personal Rules (Masterclass 6)

MOCK 1

PEARSON EDEXCEL LEVEL 1 • 60 MINUTES • 30 MARKS

Official Reading Mock Examination • Paper 1

Examination Protocol

Instructions for Candidates:

- This paper contains 3 reading texts (Text A, Text B, and Text C).
- Answer all questions in the candidate spaces provided.
- Total time allowed: 60 minutes. Total marks: 30 marks.
- You may not use a dictionary or spellchecker.

Pacing Rule

Spend 10 minutes reading all texts thoroughly before beginning the questions.

Mark Allocation

Check the marks allocated to each question. A 2-mark question requires 2 distinct points.

✎ Personal Target Score & Time Checkpoints

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 1

M1

Mock 1 • Text A: Greendale Community Health & Wellbeing Centre

Reading Passage

The Greendale Health & Wellbeing Centre opens Monday to Friday from 08:00 to 19:30. We provide free confidential health checks, regional smoking cessation clinics, and diabetes prevention workshops. To book an appointment, telephone 01632 774200 or visit our reception desk in Zone 2. Patients attending morning clinics may use the visitor car park free of charge for up to two hours.

1 **Question 1:** According to Text A, what time does the Wellbeing Centre close on weekdays? (1 mark)

2 **Question 2:** Identify two free health services offered by the centre. (2 marks)

M1

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 1

Mock 1 • Text A Continued & Questions

Reading Passage

Please note that evening workshops require advance booking at least 48 hours in advance. If you cannot attend your scheduled appointment, you must notify staff so another patient can be offered your time slot. Missed appointments cost the centre over £12,000 each year.

1 **Question 3:** How much notice is required to book an evening workshop? (1 mark)

2 **Question 4:** Explain one consequence mentioned in the text if a patient misses an appointment. (1 mark)

3 **Question 5:** What is the main purpose of Text A? (1 mark)

- ☐ To complain about regional healthcare funding
- ☐ To inform the public about services and opening hours
- ☐ To advertise private gym memberships
- ☐ To instruct readers how to train as a nurse

M1

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 1

Mock 1 • Text B: Customer Feedback & Public Reviews

Reading Passage

Review by David T. (5 Stars • Verified Visitor):
'I visited the Greendale Wellbeing Centre yesterday for a blood pressure check. The nurse, Sister Sarah, was exceptionally kind and reassuring. The modern waiting area was spotlessly clean and spacious. The automated check-in screen was effortless to use. Without a doubt, this is the finest healthcare facility in the Valleyfield district!'

1 **Question 6:** Extract one fact from David's review. (1 mark)

2 **Question 7:** Extract one opinion from David's review. (1 mark)

3 **Question 8:** Explain how David uses adjectives to describe the staff and facilities. (2 marks)

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 1

M1

Mock 1 • Text B Questions & Text C Introduction

Reading Passage

Text C • Staff Operational Memo:
From: Clinic Operations Manager
To: All Nursing & Administrative Staff
Date: 12 October 2026
Subject: Annual Flu Vaccination Clinic Logistics

All staff must complete their mandatory infection control refresher training by Friday 24 October. Flu vaccination clinics commence Monday 3 November in Seminar Room B.

1 **Question 9:** In David's review in Text B, what does the word 'reassuring' suggest about Sister Sarah? (1 mark)

2 **Question 10:** Identify the date by which staff must complete their refresher training. (1 mark)

M1

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 1

Mock 1 • Text C: Operational Memo Details

Reading Passage

To maintain efficient patient flow, please adhere strictly to the 10-minute appointment slots. Laminated patient pathway flowcharts are displayed in the staff breakroom. Any adverse vaccine reactions must be logged in the yellow clinical incident binder within 30 minutes of occurrence.

1 **Question 11:** Where can staff find the laminated patient pathway flowcharts? (1 mark)

2 **Question 12:** Where must adverse vaccine reactions be recorded? (1 mark)

3 **Question 13:** Within what timeframe must an adverse reaction be logged? (1 mark)

M1

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 1

Mock 1 • Text C Layout & Comparison Questions

Reading Passage

The memo uses bold subheadings and bullet points so that operational instructions are clear during busy clinic hours. All staff receive a complimentary hot beverage voucher from the cafeteria.

1 **Question 14:** Identify two layout features used in Text C and explain how they help the reader. (2 marks)

2 **Question 15:** Both Text A and Text C discuss healthcare clinics. Compare one difference in audience between Text A and Text C. (2 marks)

M1

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 1

Mock 1 • Mock 1 • Synthesis & Final Review

Reading Passage

Complete your review of Paper 1 before marking your score against the official solutions in the Reference Section.

1 **Question 16:** Summarise two key pieces of advice you would give to someone visiting the Greendale Centre for the first time. (2 marks)

MOCK 2

PEARSON EDEXCEL LEVEL 1 • 60 MINUTES • 30 MARKS

Official Reading Mock Examination • Paper 2

Examination Protocol

Instructions for Candidates:

- This paper contains 3 reading texts on workplace apprenticeship training and health and safety.
- Answer all questions in the spaces provided.
- Time allowed: 60 minutes. Total marks: 30 marks.
- Check your answers against the official mark scheme in the Reference Section.

Top Scoring Tip

Keep your answers precise and directly quote the passage where appropriate.

Question Phrasing

Watch out for words like 'except' or 'apart from' in retrieval questions.

✎ Personal Target Score & Time Checkpoints

M2

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 2

Mock 2 • Text A: Valleyfield Council Apprenticeship Guide

Reading Passage

The Valleyfield Council Apprenticeship Programme offers paid apprenticeships across digital skills, business administration, and horticulture. Apprentices receive a starting salary of £19,500 per annum, 25 days of paid annual leave, and fully funded qualifications up to Level 3. Applicants must be aged 16 or over and hold GCSEs in English and Maths at Grade 3 or Functional Skills Level 1.

1 **Question 1:** According to Text A, what is the starting salary for an apprentice? (1 mark)

2 **Question 2:** State two qualification fields offered on the apprenticeship programme. (2 marks)

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 2

M2

Mock 2 • Text A Continued & Questions

Reading Passage

All applications must be submitted via the online portal by Friday 28 November 2026. Successful candidates will be invited for assessment days during the second week of December. If you need reasonable adjustments for the interview, contact the disability support coordinator at hr@valleyfield.gov.uk.

1 **Question 3:** What is the final deadline date for submitting an application? (1 mark)

2 **Question 4:** Who should applicants contact if they require reasonable adjustments? (1 mark)

3 **Question 5:** What text type is Text A? (1 mark)

- [ ] An informal personal diary
- [ ] An informative official recruitment guide
- [ ] A critical newspaper review
- [ ] A recipe instruction card

M2

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 2

Mock 2 • Text B: Apprentice Case Study • Marcus

Reading Passage

Marcus Davies, Digital Support Apprentice:
'Joining the council digital team was the best decision of my career! I was nervous on my first day, but my mentor Abdul guided me through every software deployment. The workplace culture is wonderfully welcoming and positive. Last month, I configured 85 new laptops for community support staff.'

1 **Question 6:** Extract one fact from Marcus's case study. (1 mark)

2 **Question 7:** Extract one opinion from Marcus's case study. (1 mark)

3 **Question 8:** How does Marcus describe the workplace culture? (1 mark)

M2

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 2

Mock 2 • Text B Questions & Text C Introduction

Reading Passage

Text C • Depot Health & Safety Policy Notice:
All warehouse and IT depot employees must wear high-visibility vests and steel toe-capped safety boots at all times in the logistics bay. Forklift operating lanes are marked with yellow cross-hatch lines. Pedestrians must strictly use the green painted walkways.

1 **Question 9:** In Marcus's account, how did mentor Abdul support him? (1 mark)

2 **Question 10:** According to Text C, what two items of PPE are compulsory in the logistics bay? (2 marks)

M2

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 2

Mock 2 • Text C: Depot Safety Rules

Reading Passage

Mobile phones are strictly prohibited while walking through the loading bays. Earphones must never be worn as they prevent staff from hearing forklift reverse warning alarms. In the event of a spillage, immediately erect the yellow 'Caution: Wet Floor' warning cones.

1 **Question 11:** Why are earphones prohibited in the loading bays? (1 mark)

2 **Question 12:** What action must an employee take immediately if a liquid spillage occurs? (1 mark)

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 2

M2

Mock 2 • Text C Layout & Comparison Questions

Reading Passage

Text C uses bold uppercase lettering and warning symbols to emphasise urgent safety protocols. Failure to observe safety notices may result in formal disciplinary action under section 4 of the Employment Contract.

1 **Question 13:** Explain why the writer of Text C used bold uppercase lettering for key safety rules. (1 mark)

2 **Question 14:** Both Text A and Text C are written for council staff and applicants. Identify one difference in purpose between Text A and Text C. (2 marks)

M2

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 2

Mock 2 • Mock 2 • Candidate Self-Audit Matrix

Reading Passage

Check your answers against the official mark scheme before recording your final score.

1 **Question 15:** What advice does Text C give regarding mobile phone usage? (1 mark)

2 **Question 16:** Summarise two benefits of doing an apprenticeship as described across Text A and Text B. (2 marks)

MS1

RETRIEVAL & IDENTIFICATION MARK SCHEMES (L1.9, L1.13)

Official Mark Scheme • Part 1 of 6

Mark Scheme Standards & Criteria

Examiner Assessment Guidance:
Pearson Edexcel Level 1 Reading awards marks for accurate factual extraction. Accept direct quotes or unambiguous paraphrasing that answers the question precisely.

Standard Marking Rules:

- Do not penalise spelling, punctuation, or grammar errors in the Reading paper provided meaning is clear.
- Where a question asks for TWO points, do not award marks for two variations of the same idea.
- Answers copied verbatim from the text are acceptable if they answer the specific question asked.

✎ Personal Marking Notes & Checkpoints (Part 1)

MS2

LAYOUT & ORGANISATIONAL DEVICES MARK SCHEME (L1.14, L1.15)

Official Mark Scheme • Part 2 of 6

Mark Scheme Standards & Criteria

Examiner Assessment Guidance:

To achieve full marks on layout questions, candidates must identify the specific device (e.g. bullet points, headings, columns, diagrams) AND explain its functional benefit for the reader.

Standard Marking Rules:

- Do not penalise spelling, punctuation, or grammar errors in the Reading paper provided meaning is clear.
- Where a question asks for TWO points, do not award marks for two variations of the same idea.
- Answers copied verbatim from the text are acceptable if they answer the specific question asked.

✎ Personal Marking Notes & Checkpoints (Part 2)

MS3

FACT VS. OPINION ASSESSMENT CRITERIA (L1.11)

Official Mark Scheme • Part 3 of 6

Mark Scheme Standards & Criteria

Examiner Assessment Guidance:
Award 1 mark for a verifiable factual statement supported by records or metrics.
Award 1 mark for a subjective opinion containing evaluative vocabulary.

Standard Marking Rules:

- Do not penalise spelling, punctuation, or grammar errors in the Reading paper provided meaning is clear.
- Where a question asks for TWO points, do not award marks for two variations of the same idea.
- Answers copied verbatim from the text are acceptable if they answer the specific question asked.

✎ Personal Marking Notes & Checkpoints (Part 3)

MS4

VOCABULARY IN CONTEXT MARK SCHEME (L1.13, L1.16, L1.17)

Official Mark Scheme • Part 4 of 6

Mark Scheme Standards & Criteria

Examiner Assessment Guidance:
Candidates must demonstrate understanding of words in their specific sentence context and match the grammatical word class when offering a replacement.

Standard Marking Rules:

- Do not penalise spelling, punctuation, or grammar errors in the Reading paper provided meaning is clear.
- Where a question asks for TWO points, do not award marks for two variations of the same idea.
- Answers copied verbatim from the text are acceptable if they answer the specific question asked.

✎ Personal Marking Notes & Checkpoints (Part 4)

MS5

TEXT PURPOSE & AUDIENCE ASSESSMENT GRIDS (L1.12, L1.18)

Official Mark Scheme • Part 5 of 6

Mark Scheme Standards & Criteria

Examiner Assessment Guidance:
Candidates must accurately link purpose verbs (persuade, inform, explain, instruct) and target audience groups to specific evidence in the text.

Standard Marking Rules:

- Do not penalise spelling, punctuation, or grammar errors in the Reading paper provided meaning is clear.
- Where a question asks for TWO points, do not award marks for two variations of the same idea.
- Answers copied verbatim from the text are acceptable if they answer the specific question asked.

✎ Personal Marking Notes & Checkpoints (Part 5)

MS6

COMPARISON OF TWO TEXTS MARK SCHEME (L1.10)

Official Mark Scheme • Part 6 of 6

Mark Scheme Standards & Criteria

Examiner Assessment Guidance:
Award marks for direct comparative links between Text A and Text B identifying similarities or differences in ideas, audience, or perspective.

Standard Marking Rules:

- Do not penalise spelling, punctuation, or grammar errors in the Reading paper provided meaning is clear.
- Where a question asks for TWO points, do not award marks for two variations of the same idea.
- Answers copied verbatim from the text are acceptable if they answer the specific question asked.

✎ Personal Marking Notes & Checkpoints (Part 6)

REFERENCE SECTION: SOLUTIONS, GLOSSARY & INDEX

Complete Worked Solutions, Lexicon & Alphabetical Index

TOPIC 1: FACT OR OPINION SOLUTIONS

R1A Steps: 1. Fact: 'The electric delivery vans cut depot fuel expenditure by £14,500 between January and June.' (verifiable in accounting records) [1 Mark].
2. Opinion: 'They are undeniably the most stylish commercial vehicles on British roads today.' (subjective aesthetic judgment) [1 Mark].
Answer: Fact: Reduced fuel expenditure by £14,500 between January and June. | Opinion: Most stylish commercial vehicles on British roads today. **[2 Marks]**

R1B Steps: 1. Fact clause: 'The bistro charges £18.50 for its two-course lunch menu' (can be verified on the printed menu) [1 Mark].
2. Opinion clause: 'which is an outrageous price for such tiny portions' ('outrageous' and 'tiny' are subjective value judgments) [1 Mark].
Answer: Fact: The bistro charges £18.50 for its two-course lunch menu. | Opinion: It is an outrageous price for tiny portions. **[2 Marks]**

TOPIC 2: WORDS IN CONTEXT & MEANING SOLUTIONS

R2A Steps: 1. Isolate: Disconnect, switch off, or separate completely from the electrical power supply [1 Mark].
2. Imminent: About to happen immediately, instant, or looming right away [1 Mark].
Answer: Isolate = Disconnect / cut off from the power supply. | Imminent = About to happen immediately / instant. **[2 Marks]**

R2B Steps: 1. 'reservations' in a committee debate means doubts, concerns, or misgivings [1 Mark].
2. 'defer' means to postpone, delay, or put off until a later date [1 Mark].
Answer: (a) Reservations: doubts / concerns / hesitations. | (b) Defer: postpone / delay / put off. **[2 Marks]**

TOPIC 3: SPECIALIST & TECHNICAL VOCABULARY SOLUTIONS

R3A Steps: 1. (a) Contraindicated: Not advisable, unsafe, or must not be given to the patient due to risk of harm [1 Mark].
2. (b) Renal impairment: Kidney damage, kidney disease, or reduced kidney function [1 Mark].
Answer: (a) Contraindicated: Unsafe / should not be given to the patient. | (b) Renal impairment: Poor kidney function or kidney damage. **[2 Marks]**

R3B Steps: 1. (a) Intranet: A private, internal computer network accessible only to staff within that organisation [1 Mark].
2. (b) Phishing: Fraudulent/scam emails designed to trick staff into revealing passwords or sensitive data [1 Mark].
Answer: (a) Intranet: A private internal network used only inside the organisation. | (b) Phishing: Scam emails sent to steal passwords or confidential information. **[2 Marks]**

TOPIC 4: PRESENTATIONAL FEATURES SOLUTIONS

R4A Steps: 1. Features: Yellow shaded callout box AND bold capital letters on 'URGENT:' [1 Mark].
2. Purpose: Draws immediate visual attention to the time-sensitive arrival requirement (15 minutes early) so patients do not miss their MRI slot [1 Mark].
Answer: Features: Shaded yellow box and bold capital letters ('URGENT'). | Purpose: Immediately alerts patients to the requirement to arrive 15 minutes early before they read the rest of the page. **[2 Marks]**

R4B Steps: 1. Feature: Hyperlink (clickable link) [1 Mark].
2. Effect: Allows employees to open and download the required Mileage Claim Form directly with one click without having to search the intranet manually [1 Mark].
Answer: Feature: Hyperlink. | Effect: Gives staff instant one-click access to download the Mileage Claim Form without searching for it. **[2 Marks]**

REFERENCE SECTION: SOLUTIONS, GLOSSARY & INDEX (CONTINUED)

TOPIC 5: LAYOUT DEVICES & VISUAL SIGNPOSTING SOLUTIONS

R5A **Steps:** 1. Advantage 1: Aligns each month's submission cut-off date directly alongside its corresponding payday in clear rows [1 Mark].
2. Advantage 2: Enables staff to look up a specific month's deadline in seconds without misreading dates buried in a paragraph [1 Mark].
Answer: 1. Aligns cut-off dates directly next to paydays in clear rows. | 2. Allows staff to scan and find a specific month's deadline quickly without misreading. **[2 Marks]**

R5B **Steps:** 1. Device: Flowchart / sequential diagram with directional arrows [1 Mark].
2. Effectiveness: Visually guides a panicked bystander through the exact step-by-step order of life-saving actions without having to read long sentences [1 Mark].
Answer: Device: Flowchart / arrow sequence diagram. | Effectiveness: Visually shows the exact chronological order of first-aid actions so a bystander can act immediately in an emergency. **[2 Marks]**

TOPIC 6: IMAGES, DIAGRAMS, CHARTS & CAPTIONS SOLUTIONS

R6A **Steps:** 1. Effect of photograph: Provokes immediate shock, sympathy, and guilt by showing an innocent animal physically trapped in everyday litter [1 Mark].
2. Combined effect with caption: Combines emotional impact with the stark 100,000 annual death toll to prove it is a widespread crisis and persuade readers to cut plastic use [1 Mark].
Answer: The photo provokes shock and sympathy by showing a real turtle trapped in plastic, while the caption's 100,000 statistic proves the massive scale of the crisis to persuade readers to stop littering. **[2 Marks]**

R6B **Steps:** 1. Reason 1: Challenges gender stereotypes by showing that engineering apprenticeships are welcoming and accessible to women [1 Mark].
2. Reason 2: Portrays the workshop as modern, high-tech, and safety-conscious (safety goggles, CNC laser), making the course look attractive and professional [1 Mark].
Answer: 1. Encourages female applicants by showing women succeeding in engineering. | 2. Makes the course look modern, hands-on, and safe (high-tech laser cutter and safety goggles). **[2 Marks]**

TOPIC 7: LANGUAGE DEVICES & RHETORICAL TECHNIQUES SOLUTIONS

R7A **Steps:** 1. Technique: Emotive language ('Exhausted', 'dangerous', 'matter of life and death') or contrast/antithesis ('life and death') [1 Mark].
2. Effect: Elevates ward staffing levels from a routine scheduling issue into an urgent moral crisis, alarming the reader so they support safer staffing ratios [1 Mark].
Answer: Technique: Emotive language / contrast ('matter of life and death'). | Effect: Emphasizes the fatal consequences of understaffing to create urgency and compel support. **[2 Marks]**

R7B **Steps:** 1. Feature 1: Direct address ('your morning coffee', 'you can provide') — speaks directly to the individual donor [1 Mark].
2. Feature 2: Relatable financial comparison / contrast (£3.50 coffee vs a hot meal and warm blanket) or emotive language ('homeless veteran') [1 Mark].
Answer: 1. Direct address ('your', 'you'). | 2. Relatable cost comparison (£3.50 coffee vs hot meal and warm blanket) / emotive appeal ('homeless veteran'). **[2 Marks]**

TOPIC 8: POINT OF VIEW, BIAS & LINE OF ARGUMENT SOLUTIONS

R8A **Steps:** 1. Stance: Strongly opposed to the proposed shift roster overhaul [1 Mark].
2. Bias Reason: Uses extreme, emotionally loaded language ('unmitigated disaster', 'exploit') and assumes bad motives without presenting any of management's operational reasons [1 Mark].
Answer: Stance: Strongly opposes the new shift roster. | Bias: Uses loaded emotional words ('unmitigated disaster', 'exploit') and presents a one-sided view without management's perspective. **[2 Marks]**

R8B **Steps:** 1. Sentence 1 (Counter-argument): Acknowledges the opposing concern from retailers that banning cars might reduce passing trade [1 Mark].
2. Sentence 2 (Rebuttal with Evidence): Rebuts that fear using statistical evidence from 14 UK towns showing a 28% rise in footfall and 50% fewer empty shops [1 Mark].
3. Sentence 3 (Conclusion): Concludes that the council should approve the pedestrianisation scheme immediately [1 Mark].
Answer: 1. Acknowledges retailers' fear of losing car trade. 2. Counters this with data from 14 UK towns showing a 28% footfall increase. 3. Concludes that the council should approve pedestrianisation immediately. **[3 Marks]**

REFERENCE SECTION: SOLUTIONS, GLOSSARY & INDEX (CONTINUED)

TOPIC 9: TONE, STYLE & WRITER'S VOICE SOLUTIONS

R9A **Steps:** 1. Style/Tone: Informal, conversational, friendly, and relatable [1 Mark].
2. Colloquial Quote: 'We get it' or 'feels like a total chore' [1 Mark].
Answer: Tone: Conversational, friendly, and informal. | Quote: 'We get it' (or 'feels like a total chore'). **[2 Marks]**

R9B **Steps:** 1. Tone/Style: Formal, authoritative, strict, and impersonal [1 Mark].
2. Grammatical feature: Passive voice ('must be worn', 'are strictly prohibited') or strong modal/adverbial emphasis ('must', 'strictly prohibited') [1 Mark].
Answer: Tone/Style: Formal, strict, and authoritative. | Feature: Passive voice ('must be worn') and strong modal/adverbial phrasing ('strictly prohibited'). **[2 Marks]**

TOPIC 10: TEXT TYPES, GENRE CONVENTIONS & AUDIENCE SOLUTIONS

R10A **Steps:** 1. Text type: Online discussion forum / message board thread [1 Mark].
2. Reason for reading: To read real-world recommendations, personal opinions, and reviews from fellow tradespeople about durable winter work boots [1 Mark].
Answer: Text type: Online discussion forum thread. | Purpose for reader: To gather firsthand tips and reviews from other tradespeople on the best waterproof work boots. **[2 Marks]**

R10B **Steps:** 1. Target audience: Outpatient receptionists at the medical practice [1 Mark].
2. Main purpose: To inform and instruct reception staff on the updated procedures for checking patient prescription exemptions [1 Mark].
Answer: Target Audience: Outpatient receptionists. | Main Purpose: To inform/instruct staff on the updated procedure for checking prescription exemptions. **[2 Marks]**

TOPIC 11: COMPARING TEXTS & CONTRASTING PERSPECTIVES SOLUTIONS

R11A **Steps:** 1. Viewpoint contrast: Text A views video consultations positively as convenient and safe for busy workers ('eliminating travel time'), whereas Text B views them negatively as excluding older people ('alienates elderly patients') [2 Marks].
2. Language contrast: Text A uses positive verbs ('empower') and a statistic ('50%'), whereas Text B uses emotive vocabulary ('alienates') to highlight digital exclusion [1 Mark].
Answer: Text A presents video appointments positively as convenient and hygienic, using the verb 'empower' and a '50%' statistic. In contrast, Text B criticises them for excluding older people without broadband, using the emotive verb 'alienates'. **[3 Marks]**

R11B **Steps:** 1. Stance comparison: Text A supports the four-day week as a proven success for wellbeing and profits, whereas Text B opposes it as financially impossible for small seven-day retail shops [2 Marks].
2. Evidence/Tone comparison: Text A relies on measured trial statistics ('sick leave dropped by 62%', 'revenue rose by 8%'), whereas Text B uses dramatic, emotive hyperbole ('go bankrupt!') [1 Mark].
Answer: Text A supports the four-day week using positive trial statistics ('sick leave dropped by 62%', 'revenue rose by 8%'). Conversely, Text B argues it only suits desk jobs and uses emotive exaggeration ('go bankrupt!') to warn that small shops cannot afford extra staffing costs. **[3 Marks]**

REFERENCE SECTION: SOLUTIONS, GLOSSARY & INDEX (CONTINUED)

TOPIC 12: THE WRITER'S PURPOSE & TARGET AUDIENCE SOLUTIONS

R12A **Steps:** 1. Main purpose: To persuade/campaign for equal public health funding for community palliative care services by highlighting patient dignity [1 Mark].
2. Target audience: Newspaper readers, voters, and healthcare policymakers/commissioners [1 Mark].
Answer: Main Purpose: To persuade the public and policymakers that community palliative care deserves equal public health funding. | Target Audience: Adult newspaper readers and healthcare decision-makers. **[2 Marks]**

R12B **Steps:** 1. Identification: To advise [1 Mark].
2. Explanation: It offers optional, money-saving suggestions ('If you want to...', 'try bleeding...') to help householders lower their bills, rather than mandatory safety commands [1 Mark].
Answer: To advise — it offers helpful, optional money-saving tips ('If you want to...', 'try bleeding...') rather than compulsory rules. **[2 Marks]**

OFFICIAL READING MOCK PAPER 1 • SOLUTIONS (QUESTIONS 1–8)

Q1 19:30 (7:30 pm) **[1m]**
Direct retrieval from Text A paragraph 1.

Q2 Health checks / Smoking cessation clinics / Diabetes prevention workshops (any two) **[2m]**
1 mark for each service listed.

Q3 48 hours in advance **[1m]**
Direct retrieval.

Q4 Costs the centre over £12,000 / denies another patient a time slot **[1m]**
Accept either consequence.

Q5 B: To inform the public about services and opening hours **[1m]**
Multiple choice correct key.

Q6 Visited yesterday / Nurse was Sister Sarah / Had blood pressure check **[1m]**
Verifiable fact.

Q7 Sister Sarah was exceptionally kind / Finest healthcare facility in the Valleyfield district **[1m]**
Subjective opinion.

Q8 Kind, reassuring, clean, spacious — creates an encouraging and positive impression **[2m]**
1 mark for quote, 1 mark for effect.

OFFICIAL READING MOCK PAPER 1 • SOLUTIONS (QUESTIONS 9–16)

Q9 She made the patient feel calm, relaxed, and safe during the test **[1m]**
Vocabulary inference.

Q10 Friday 24 October **[1m]**
Direct retrieval.

Q11 In the staff breakroom **[1m]**
Direct retrieval.

Q12 Yellow clinical incident binder **[1m]**
Direct retrieval.

Q13 Within 30 minutes of occurrence **[1m]**
Direct retrieval.

Q14 Bold headings organise topics; bullet points present rules clearly for quick reading **[2m]**
1m for features, 1m for effect.

Q15 Text A is for general public/patients; Text C is for internal clinical/administrative staff **[2m]**
1m for Text A audience, 1m for Text C.

Q16 Book evening workshops 48h in advance; use free 2-hour parking for morning clinics **[2m]**
1m for each valid recommendation.

OFFICIAL READING MOCK PAPER 2 • SOLUTIONS (QUESTIONS 1–8)

Q1 £19,500 per annum **[1m]**
Direct retrieval from Text A.

Q2 Digital skills / Business administration / Horticulture (any two) **[2m]**
1m each.

Q3 Friday 28 November 2026 **[1m]**
Direct retrieval.

Q4 Disability support coordinator (hr@valleyfield.gov.uk) **[1m]**
Direct retrieval.

Q5 B: An informative official recruitment guide **[1m]**
Multiple choice key.

Q6 Configured 85 new laptops / Mentor was Abdul **[1m]**
Verifiable fact.

Q7 Best decision of my career / Wonderfully welcoming workplace culture **[1m]**
Subjective opinion.

Q8 Wonderfully welcoming and positive **[1m]**
Direct quote.

REFERENCE SECTION: SOLUTIONS, GLOSSARY & INDEX (CONTINUED)

OFFICIAL READING MOCK PAPER 2 • SOLUTIONS (QUESTIONS 9–16)

Q9 Abdul guided him through software deployments and helped him overcome first-day nerves **[1m]**
Explanation.

Q10 High-visibility vests AND steel toe-capped safety boots **[2m]**
1m for each PPE item.

Q11 They prevent workers from hearing forklift reverse warning alarms **[1m]**
Safety justification.

Q12 Erect yellow 'Caution: Wet Floor' warning cones immediately **[1m]**
Action required.

Q13 To emphasise urgent mandatory health and safety rules so they are immediately noticed **[1m]**
Layout effect.

Q14 Text A aims to recruit and inform applicants; Text C aims to enforce strict depot safety rules **[2m]**
Purpose comparison.

Q15 Mobile phones are strictly prohibited while walking through loading bays **[1m]**
Rule retrieval.

Q16 Earn a salary while training (£19,500); receive mentorship from Abdul and gain funded qualifications **[2m]**
Synthesis across texts.

READING GLOSSARY (A–I)

Audience: The specific group of readers a text is written for (e.g. staff, patients, general public).

Bias: A one-sided viewpoint that favours one perspective over another, often lacking balance.

Caption: A brief text explanation placed beneath an image, chart, or diagram.

Context: The surrounding words, sentences, or situation that gives a word or text its meaning.

Fact: A verifiable piece of information that can be proven true by records, measurements, or evidence.

Headline / Heading: The main title of an article or document designed to state the subject clearly.

Implicit Meaning: Information that is suggested or hinted at rather than directly stated.

Informative Text: A text whose main purpose is to give clear, factual information to the reader.

READING GLOSSARY (L–T)

Layout Feature: A visual or structural element (columns, bullet points, boxes) that organises content.

Opinion: A personal belief, attitude, or feeling that cannot be verified as an objective fact.

Persuasive Text: A text designed to convince the reader to take action or agree with a viewpoint.

Purpose: The main reason why the author wrote the text (to inform, instruct, explain, or persuade).

Retrieval: Finding and extracting specific facts, figures, or dates directly from a text.

Subheading: A smaller heading that divides an article or document into clear sections.

Tone: The mood, feeling, or attitude conveyed by the writer's choice of words.

ALPHABETICAL SUBJECT INDEX (A–I)

A

Audience Identification p.41, 49, 53
Author Purpose p.49, 53

B

Bias Detection p.33, 57
Bullet Points Effect p.17, 21, 56

C

Captions & Diagrams p.25
Comparing Texts p.45, 58
Context Meaning p.9, 55

E

Examiner Traps p.5, 9, 13
Explicit Meaning p.9

F

Fact vs. Opinion p.5, 57
Fonts & Headings p.17, 21

G

Glossary of Terms p.86
Golden Reading Rules p.5, 9, 13, 17

I

Implicit Meaning p.9, 25
Informative Purpose p.41, 49

REFERENCE SECTION: SOLUTIONS, GLOSSARY & INDEX (CONTINUED)

ALPHABETICAL SUBJECT INDEX (L–T)

L

Layout Devices p.17, 21, 56
Locating Facts p.54

M

Mock Exam Paper 1 p.59
Mock Exam Paper 2 p.67

O

Opinions Identification p.5, 57
Organisational Devices p.17, 21

P

Persuasive Techniques p.29, 41
Purpose of Texts p.41, 49

R

Retrieval Skills p.54
Rhetorical Questions p.29

S

Specialist Vocabulary p.13
Subheadings Effect p.17, 21

T

Text Types p.41
Timing Strategy (2 min/mark) p.3, 53
Tone & Style p.37

Candidate Reading Notes

READY

FINAL REVISION • EXAM READINESS

Level 1 Reading • Exam Day Commitments

Golden Exam Rules for Reading Success

Before entering your Pearson Edexcel Level 1 Reading examination, commit to these 5 essentials:

- **1. Read Questions First:** Always read the questions before the source texts so you read with focus.
- **2. Strict Pacing:** Spend 10 minutes reading texts, 40 minutes on questions, and 10 minutes checking.
- **3. Quote Directly:** For retrieval questions, quote exact words or statistics from the source passage.
- **4. Explain Layout:** When asked about layout features, always state how they help the reader.
- **5. Answer Every Question:** Never leave a multiple-choice question blank — eliminate wrong answers.

✎ Personal Commitments & Tutor Sign-off

Everything you need to master Functional Skills English LEVEL 1 Reading

Engineered specifically for Pearson Edexcel Functional Skills English LEVEL 1. Every topic features authentic non-fiction texts, clear breakdown of question styles, examiner traps, and complete mark schemes.

WHAT MAKES THIS READING GUIDE DIFFERENT

- **12 Complete Reading Topics:** Fact vs opinion, context meaning, specialist terms, layout devices, and organizational features.
- **Authentic Workplace Passages:** Realistic emails, news articles, policies, notices, and instructions.
- **2 Full Practice Papers:** Built to exact Pearson Edexcel Level 1 timing and question specifications.
- **Full Step-by-Step Solutions:** Detailed answer keys and marking guidance for self-assessment.

COMPLETE PREPARATION FOR EXAM DAY

Includes 2 complete authentic Reading Mock Examinations with full texts, retrieval, inference, and comparison tasks matching Pearson Edexcel standards.

Published by Master Functional Skills
masterfunctionalskills.co.uk • DarkNight Publishing
DfE 2018 Standards • Pearson Edexcel Specification

978-1-916844-01-2